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CART 315 Digital Game Prototype

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Reflective Journal: Creating a Walking Simulator on Unity

Creating a walking simulator in Unity was a learning experience that required me to rethink my approach to building the assignment. Initially I tried using a premade template, but realized that starting over with a new template was the better way forward. Although redoing the project meant spending extra time building the environment, it gave me a better opportunity to understand how the different elements of the game worked together.

One of the first challenges I encountered was creating the plane for the environment and applying its texture. After adding the trees from a free asset on unity to scene, I noticed that their textures and meshes were not loading correctly. This was made worse by the fact that after saving the project and pushing it onto GitHub, it was discovered that the project had gone back to its basic form consisting of the planes without the texture and the trees. This taught me how important it is to ensure that all the assets are saved before committing and pushing the project to a repository.

Once the scene was created, I started the process of restoring the trees in order to get the textures right. Once this was done, I then used a grass texture on the planes, and this helped make the scene much more realistic. This process has taught me how important it is to have textures in order to create the atmosphere.

The final stage involved adding sounds throughout the environment. This increased immersion for the walking simulator as the experience did not depend on the visual aspect only. It created an atmosphere that made the player believe that he or she can explore that environment.

In summary, this project has taught me that making a game is not just about placing assets in the scene. I had to deal with some technical challenges, redesign some aspects of the project and be more careful when it comes to saving and committing my changes on GitHub. Even though it was very frustrating to restart everything from scratch, it allowed me to understand how crucial it is to choose the right starting point

and slowly build up the scene. In all future work, I will save my modifications, test if the assets are loading properly, and test the scene after each modification.